

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 37

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "REVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

The text for this lesson is **Matthew 18:1–11**, which we will read in Nancy's translation.

¹At that time the disciples came to Jesus and said, "Who then is greatest in the kingdom of the heavens?" ²And Jesus invited a little child to Himself and set the child before them ³and said, "What I say to you is real. Unless you turn around and become like children, you will not enter the kingdom of the heavens. ⁴Anyone then who gives up their pride like this child is the greatest in the kingdom of the heavens. ⁵And whoever, in My name, receives one like this child, receives Me; ⁶but for whoever trips and entraps one of these little ones who trusts Me—for that one, it would be better to have a heavy millstone hung around his or her neck and be drowned in the depth of the sea. ⁷Woe to the world because it trips and entraps! What I mean is this: tripping and entrapments are inevitable, but there is further woe to that person through whom the tripping and entrapments come! ⁸Let me explain. If your hand or your foot trips and entraps you, cut it off and throw it from you. It is better for you to enter life crippled or lame than to have two hands or two feet and be cast into the eternal fire. ⁹If your eye trips and entraps you, pluck it out and throw it from you. It is better for you to enter life with one eye than to have two eyes and be cast into the fiery hell. ¹⁰See that you do not disdain and undervalue one of these little ones, for I say to you that their angels in the heavens continually see the face of My Father, who is in the heavens. ¹¹For the Son of Man has come to rescue that which was lost.

Take a deep breath.

When Nancy was very neurotic and compulsive, she understood this passage to mean that in order to experience the life that God intended for her, she would have to practice great self-discipline and self-denial. She was taught to discount and even deny her real abilities and to abhor rather than explore her real assets in case they were a danger to her soul or the souls of others. Humility, as she understood it, was a synonym for self-loathing. She did not realize that what she thought was humility and sacrifice was actually neurotic pride.

Caring for our little ones is, of course, of vital importance, but in this passage Jesus is also talking about us. The "little one" is your True Self. Jesus is teaching us that in order to become great in His kingdom, we must give up our pride and turn back to our original design. Turning back to our original design means giving up the Idol Self that we have created, with its legal systems, pride, and fear-driven choices. That's

going to feel really uncomfortable. If we choose to resist the demands of the Idol, it will try to drive us back into slavery by punishing us with feelings of guilt, anxiety, and shame. When we slip out from under the Idol's control, we will often find ourselves acting in ways that seem immature and messy because we need training—and that can feel humiliating, too. God's intention is for children to develop the potential of their original design with the support of loving karis relationships. In a similar way, it is with the help of the karis community that we, as adults, develop the potential of our original design.

Yes, it is a painful reality of life that you will trip, make mistakes, and encounter traps. It is even more painful to realize that you often trip and entrap yourself. These traps sabotage your true development. Even the natural talents and abilities that you are proud of can trip and entrap you, and it can be painful when you realize that you are using those strengths to support your search for glory. Rather than condemning yourself for the misuse of your strengths, you can use your KF tools to unseat the Idol and learn how to employ those talents and abilities to fulfill your real potential and mission. With the help of your tools, you can let go of feeling entitled to familiar, convenient, and easy resolutions to your problems. You can let go of your slavery to the exalted and unrealistic goals that you impose on yourself and others. Instead, you can choose to become like a healthy, supported little child again. You can explore your design and potential with eager wonder and with a childlike desire and determination to become like the Father who created you.

Your little child got lost, but Jesus is seeking for you. It would help if you would stop running, hiding, and fighting the process of being found. By avoiding your connection with your Creator, you are resisting the heavens, and that can't help but hurt you. Jesus calls that hurt, *woe*. While He is seeking you, He would rather you be seeking Him. What a marvelous reunion that would be!

Our prayer might go something like this:

Savior, come and find me, whatever it takes. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together to heal. Teach us childlike wonder as You continue to guide us to our glory and our truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with You. Help us invest in our true design by shedding old patterns of idolatry, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.